goes from code commit to releasable software. It should be automated as much as possible, and it should represent the only path to production.

Based on the concepts described by Jez Humble and Dave Farley in their *Continuous Delivery* book (Addison-Wesley Professional, 2010) and by Dave Farley in his *Continuous Delivery Pipelines* book (2021), we can identify a few key stages in a deployment pipeline:

- *Commit stage*—After a developer commits new code to the mainline, this stage goes through build, unit tests, integration tests, static code analysis, and packaging. At the end of this stage, an executable application artifact is published to an artifact repository. It is a *release candidate*. For example, it can be a JAR artifact published to a Maven repository or a container image published to a container registry. This stage supports the continuous integration practice. It's supposed to be fast, possibly under five minutes, to provide developers with fast feedback about their changes and allow them to move on to the next task.